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Disabled Albertans to receive letters this month about their AISH eligibility

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Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services Jason Nixon released details about the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) on May 12, 2026 in preparation for its July launch. (File photo from the Alberta Legislative Assembly on Flickr)

The province is pushing ahead with plans to introduce its new program on July 1 for citizens with disabilities despite the concerns raised by municipalities and disabled Albertans. This month Assured Income for Severely Handicapped (AISH) recipients will find out if they will remain on AISH or be switched to the Alberta Disabilities Assistance Program (ADAP) with less financial support and be expected to find employment.

The province says about 50,000 Albertans will transition to ADAP, and 30,000 current AISH clients will remain on AISH.

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Red Deer AISH recipient Crystal, who has not yet received a letter about her eligible to remain AISH, wondered why the provincial government expects companies will hire people who might not be able to do the job.

“If we wanted this, why would we be fighting it? It’s not as easy to get a job. I’ve been fired multiple times because of having a disability,” Crystal said.

“They should just leave (AISH) the way it is. People that wanted to work, could work.”

She said many disabled Albertans don’t want ADAP, and neither do several municipalities, including Red Deer. City council has called on the province to pause ADAP and changes to AISH, and undertake meaningful consultation and publicly report on the social and economic impacts of the proposed changes.

The province says ADAP was designed based on feedback from Albertans with disabilities, advocacy organizations and service providers.

“We made a promise to Albertans to improve supports for persons with disabilities, and with the launch of ADAP, we’re delivering on that promise. To the thousands of Albertans with disabilities who have been overlooked for decades and will finally be able to receive the support they need from ADAP – we see you, we hear you, and help is coming this July,” said Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services Minister Jason Nixon, in a statement.

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ADAP recipients will be able to earn up to \$700 per month before financial benefits are reduced, which is the highest employment income limit of any comparable disability income assistance program in Canada, says the province.

ADAP clients will also receive a \$200 monthly transition benefit until December 2027 when their monthly living allowance will drop to \$1,740 compared to \$1,940 for those on AISH.

AISH clients will automatically remain on AISH unless they have a severe and profound developmental disability, and/or deemed eligible for or are receiving Persons with Developmental Disabilities services, those with palliative or terminal medical conditions, living in continuing care homes, age 60 or older, or choose to transition to ADAP.

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